



We have also adopted sophisticated business intelligence and data analytics tools to optimize production, streamline sales processes, and manage inventory more effectively. Moreover, NMDC has integrated belt scales with SCADA and ERP systems for real-time production data monitoring and is currently working on integrating freight operations for accurate dispatch tracking. These tools analyze vast amounts of operational data, delivering actionable insights that drive efficiency and profitability.

In the past five years, we have invested over ₹150 crore in research and development, focusing on sustainable mineral technology and ore beneficiation. Our state-of-the-art R&D center, equipped with cutting-edge laboratories, is a hub for innovation in mineralogy, characterization, and processing techniques.

Through these comprehensive digital transformation efforts, NMDC is not only optimizing its operations but also setting a new industry standard for innovation and efficiency. These initiatives are key to NMDC's ambition of becoming a 100 MTPA production capacity company by 2030.

How are you steering the mining sector in giving impetus to the nation's infrastructure development ambitions and goals?

NMDC has always played a pivotal role in advancing India's infrastructure development by ensuring a steady supply of essential raw materials like iron ore, which are foundational to sectors such as steel, construction, and manufacturing. With the Government of India's infrastructure development goals set to significantly boost demand in the iron and steel sector, NMDC is committed to ensuring raw material security through continuous efforts to enhance production and evacuation infrastructure. We are on track to increase our production from 45

million tonnes in FY24 to about 50 million tonnes in FY25, with a long-term goal of becoming a 100 million tonnes mining capacity company by 2030-31. This ambitious growth will elevate NMDC's market share in the domestic iron ore market from the current 16% to over 20%, positioning us as a key enabler of the nation's infrastructure goals.

To align with these goals, we are expanding our rail transport infrastructure by increasing the KK line's capacity from 28 MTPA to 40 MTPA, laying a 15 MTPA slurry pipeline, and constructing blending yards to better serve our customers. These investments in infrastructure not only secure the supply chain but also ensure that the basic raw materials needed for infrastructure projects are readily available, fueling the construction of roads, bridges, railways, and other critical infrastructure vital for the nation's growth.

As India continues to evolve as a global economic power, NMDC's contributions will be integral to the nation's journey towards robust, resilient, and sustainable infrastructure.

India possesses significant advantages when it comes to its iron ore and mineral reserves.

In this context, what are the crucial aspects in ensuring self-sufficiency in minerals, and iron ore, and how is NMDC exploiting these advantages to the fullest to secure India's position in the global market?

India's rich reserves of iron ore and minerals provide a strategic advantage in achieving self-sufficiency in critical resources. As the fourth-largest producer of iron ore globally, India is well-positioned to leverage these vast reserves, and at NMDC, we are dedicated to maximizing the nation's mineral resources through efficient extraction, value addition, and sustainable practices.

To ensure self-sufficiency, NMDC is significantly

investing in advanced exploration techniques and enhancing beneficiation processes. For instance, we are constructing a 4 MTPA beneficiation plant in Bachel and a 2 MTPA Pellet Plant at Nagarnar, with provisions to expand to 6 MTPA. These facilities will enable us to blend low-grade iron ore with high-grade ore and efficiently utilize tailings and slimes, ensuring optimal resource extraction and minimal wastage. Additionally, NMDC has established a pilot-scale beneficiation testing facility at its R&D Centre to develop processes for upgrading low grade iron ore, further enhancing our capacity to make the most of our available resources.

Recognizing the importance of diversifying our resource base, NMDC is also expanding production capacity and diversifying into other minerals. Our strategic move to start production in the 8 MTPA coking coal block aims to reduce India's dependency on coking coal imports. Moreover, understanding India's lack of domestic reserves for essential minerals like lithium, cobalt, and nickel, NMDC is actively pursuing overseas mining opportunities through our subsidiary, Legacy Iron Ore Limited (LIOL).

To ensure self-sufficiency, NMDC is investing in advanced exploration techniques, enhancing beneficiation processes, and collaborating with research institutions like the School of Engineering Sciences and Technology (SEST), University of Hyderabad, IITs, CSIR-IMMT etc. for innovative solutions.

We are also aligning our operations with government initiatives like Make in India and the National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP), which emphasize domestic production and minimizing reliance on external sources.

By leveraging our expertise and resources, our endeavour is to position India as a leader in the